



the reason why when you google gyroscopes you'll see wheels spinning at odd angles when dangled on a string.

The word 'gyroscope' from the greek word *gyros*, meaning 'circle' because the device demonstrates that the earth rotates and *kropos* meaning 'watcher'.

Take two gyroscopes with their axles at right angles to one another on a platform. Place this platform inside a set of gimbals (a gimbal is a pivoted support that allows the rotation of an object around a single axis.). The platform should, unless you did something odd, remain completely rigid as the gimbals rotate freely. You've now developed the basis of the inertial navigation systems (INS), used in ships, aircrafts, submarines, guided missiles and spacecrafts.

Hard Drive

Created by IBM in 1956, the first hard drive – a popular data storage device – was made from 50 24-inch discs contained inside a cabinet that was as large as a cupboard! The whole thing had a whopping capacity of 5 MB and could only be leased at a cost of \$3,200 per month. The first commercially